

Tukul.com Dashboard UI/UX Direction — Sidebar & Navigation Concept

1. Core Design Philosophy

The Tukul.com platform must adopt a modern SaaS dashboard experience similar to:

- Linear
- Notion
- Airbnb Host Dashboard
- Stripe
- ClickUp
- Framer
- Vercel
- Monday.com

The design should feel:

- lightweight,
- spacious,
- premium,
- minimal,
- responsive,
- and smooth.

The current sidebar concept is acceptable as a base, but it still looks:

- too static,
- too narrow,
- slightly outdated,
- and visually disconnected from the main content area.

We want the navigation to feel “alive”, smooth, and adaptive.

2. Sidebar UX Objective

The sidebar should support 2 modes:

A. Expanded Mode

Used when users want full navigation visibility.

Display:

- logo
- menu labels
- icons
- grouped categories
- user profile section
- quick actions

Example:

- Dashboard
 - Projects
 - Quotations
 - Contractors
 - Property Owners
 - Messages
 - Payments
 - Analytics
 - Settings
-

B. Collapsed Mode

Used to maximize workspace area.

Only display:

- icons
- active-state indicator

- hover tooltip

This is important because:

- contractors may use tablets/laptops onsite,
- project management pages require large working space,
- bidding tables and project timelines need wide layouts.

The transition between expanded ↔ collapsed must be:

- animated,
- smooth,
- fast,
- and visually polished.

NOT abrupt.

3. Desired Modern Sidebar Behaviour

Smooth Expand/Collapse Animation

When collapsing:

- text fades out smoothly,
- sidebar width shrinks gradually,
- icons remain centered,
- spacing auto-adjusts.

Animation target:

~200ms–300ms ease-in-out.

Active Menu Highlight

The active page should have:

- soft background highlight,
- left border/accent line,

- slightly stronger icon color,
- modern hover effect.

Avoid:

- ✗ harsh blue blocks
- ✗ old-school gradients
- ✗ sharp borders

Use:

- ✓ soft glassmorphism/minimal card feel
- ✓ subtle shadows
- ✓ soft neutral backgrounds

Floating / Modern Feel

The sidebar should not feel “attached rigidly”.

Use:

- soft rounded corners,
- spacing around edges,
- subtle shadow,
- breathing room.

Modern SaaS dashboards avoid edge-to-edge heavy layouts.

4. Navigation Structure Recommendation

The menu should be grouped clearly.

Example:

MAIN

- Dashboard
- Projects
- Marketplace

- Quotations

MANAGEMENT

- Contractors
- Property Owners
- Staff
- Documents

FINANCIAL

- Payments
- Wallet
- Invoices

COMMUNICATION

- Messages
- Notifications
- Support Tickets

SYSTEM

- Reports
- Analytics
- Settings

This structure is psychologically easier for users.

5. Mobile & Tablet Behaviour (VERY IMPORTANT)

Tukul.com will have many contractor users onsite using phones/tablets.

Therefore:

Desktop

Persistent collapsible sidebar.

Tablet

Partially collapsible overlay sidebar.

Mobile

Sidebar becomes:

- slide-out drawer,
- hidden by default,
- opened via hamburger button.

This responsiveness is mandatory.

NOT optional.

6. UI Styling Direction

Typography

Use modern fonts:

- Inter
- Plus Jakarta Sans
- Geist
- SF Pro style

Avoid outdated typography.

Spacing

Use generous whitespace.

Modern premium UI = less clutter.

Icons

Use consistent icon system:

- Lucide
- Heroicons

- Phosphor

Avoid mixed icon styles.

Colors

Use neutral modern palette:

- white
- off-white
- soft gray
- charcoal
- one strong accent color

Avoid excessive colors.

7. Important UX Psychology

The platform must reduce user mental fatigue.

Contractors and property owners are NOT tech experts.

Therefore:

- navigation must feel obvious,
- interface must feel calming,
- users should immediately understand where they are.

Good UI increases:

- trust,
- retention,
- conversion,
- time spent on platform,
- and perceived company value.

People judge platform quality within seconds.

8. Long-Term Scalability Requirement

The sidebar/navigation must be designed to scale from:

- 10 features
to
- 100+ features in the future.

Therefore:

- modular architecture is required,
- grouped navigation is required,
- expandable submenu support is required,
- role-based menu rendering is required.

Example:

- contractor sees contractor menus,
- property owner sees owner menus,
- admin sees admin tools.

9. Technical Implementation Direction

Developer should use:

- responsive layout system,
- reusable sidebar component,
- animation library,
- state persistence.

Recommended:

- TailwindCSS
- Framer Motion
- Radix UI / shadcn/ui

Sidebar state should persist:

- if user collapses sidebar,
 - remember preference on next login.
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10. Final Vision

The final experience should make users feel:

“This platform is modern, trustworthy, professional, and easy to use.”

NOT:

- crowded,
- technical,
- confusing,
- or outdated.

Tukul.com should visually compete with modern global SaaS platforms, not traditional contractor management systems.